

THE GIFT SHOP POS

Complete User Guide & Reference Manual

Installation • Daily Operation • Reports • Admin Settings

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1. Welcome

Thank you for choosing The Gift Shop POS. This guide covers everything from installing the app for the first time through to the advanced reporting and admin tools — written for shop owners and staff, not developers.

The Gift Shop POS is a point-of-sale register built for independent retail: gift shops, boutiques, and souvenir stores. It runs on your own Windows PC or Mac, works fully offline once set up, and supports the day-to-day realities of small retail — multiple staff with different access levels, consignment vendors, multi-currency tourist trade, and detailed end-of-day reporting.

What's in this guide:

- Installing the app on Windows and macOS
- First-time setup: your store name, admin password, and opening float
- Daily use: logging in, making sales, taking payment, printing receipts
- Managing inventory, vendors, invoices, and consignment payouts
- Reports: end-of-day balancing, profit & loss, forecasting, and more
- The full Admin settings reference
- Backups, licensing, and troubleshooting

Tip: this guide follows the same order you'll naturally use the app in — install, set up once, then use every day. Keep it handy for the first week or two; after that, most of this becomes second nature.

2. Installing the App

The Gift Shop POS is distributed directly from your supplier rather than through the Windows Store or Mac App Store. Because of that, both Windows and macOS show a one-time security notice the first time you open it. This is completely normal for independently distributed software and does not mean anything is wrong with your download.

2.1 Windows Installation

1. Download the installer file (.exe) from the link your supplier provided.
2. Double-click the downloaded file to run it.
3. You will likely see a blue "Windows protected your PC" screen. This appears because the installer isn't yet registered with Microsoft — it does not mean the file is damaged or unsafe.
4. Click "More info", then click "Run anyway".
5. Follow the installer prompts (choose an install location if asked, then click through to Finish).
6. Launch The Gift Shop POS from the Start Menu or your desktop shortcut.

You will only see the SmartScreen warning on this first run. If your antivirus software quarantines or flags the installer, this is a known false-positive pattern for independently distributed desktop apps; restore the file from quarantine and reinstall, or contact your supplier for help.

2.2 macOS Installation

macOS is stricter about this than Windows: it will likely say the app "cannot be opened" or "is damaged and should be moved to the Trash." Again — this is Apple's Gatekeeper reacting to an app that isn't notarized through the Mac App Store, not a real problem with your copy.

Quickest method (2 minutes):

1. Drag "The Gift Shop POS.app" into your Mac's Applications folder.
2. Open Terminal (press Command + Space, type "Terminal", press Enter).
3. Paste this command and press Enter: `xattr -cr "/Applications/The Gift Shop POS.app"`
4. Open the app — double-click it in Applications.

Prefer not to use Terminal? Use this instead:

1. Drag the app into your Applications folder.
2. Hold Control and right-click on "The Gift Shop POS".
3. Choose "Open" from the menu, then click "Open" again in the confirmation dialog.

If neither option shows an "Open Anyway" choice, check System Settings → Privacy & Security, scroll down, and look for a message about the app being blocked with an Open Anyway button.

2.3 First Launch

The very first time you open The Gift Shop POS, it goes straight into the setup wizard described in Section 3 — there's nothing to configure beforehand. If you're reinstalling on a second computer for the same store, restore your data from a backup file instead of starting the wizard from scratch (see Section 15, Backups & Data Safety).

3. First-Time Setup

The first time the app opens on a new computer, a two-step setup wizard walks you through the essentials. You only see this once (unless you re-run it later from Admin settings).

3.1 Step 1 — Store Name & Admin Password

Enter your store's name (this appears on receipts and throughout the app) and choose whether to set a new admin password now or keep the default for the moment.

The default admin PIN is admin123. You can keep it for now and change it later from Admin → Staff & Cashier Security, but we strongly recommend setting your own before you start taking real payments — the admin account can see every sale, price, and report in the store.

3.2 Step 2 — Opening Cash Float

Count the physical cash sitting in your drawer and enter that amount as your opening float. This is the starting point for the day's cash reconciliation — it gets compared against your actual counted cash when you close out at the end of the day (Section 13).

Four quick-select buttons are provided for common float amounts, or type your own. An optional notes field lets you record anything unusual about the count.

Once confirmed, the register opens and you're ready to sell.

3.3 Activating Your License

The Gift Shop POS runs on a 14-day free trial from first launch — no license needed to explore the app. A small badge in the corner shows how many trial days remain.

When you're ready to purchase (or once the trial ends), you'll be asked for two things:

- The purchase email you used at checkout
- The license key emailed to you at the time of purchase

Enter both on the activation screen and click Activate License. The app checks the key online once — after that, it's cached on that computer and The Gift Shop POS runs completely offline from then on, exactly as before. If you don't have an internet connection at the exact moment you activate, try again once you're back online.

Lost your key? Contact your supplier's support email — it's shown right on the activation screen.

4. Daily Login & Getting Started

4.1 Staff Login

Every staff member signs in with a short PIN rather than typing a username and password each time — quick enough to use between customers. Select your name (or enter your username) and enter your PIN to start your session.

4.2 Staff Roles

Each staff account is assigned one of four roles. Admin has full access to everything in this guide; the other three roles are cashier-level accounts with an increasing set of permissions, which the store admin controls individually for each person (see Section 14.2).

Role	Typical use
Cashier	Front-of-house sales: ring up items, take payment, print receipts.
Senior Cashier	Everything a Cashier can do, plus extra permissions the admin chooses to grant (e.g. processing refunds).
Shift Lead	A trusted staff member who can approve sensitive actions for others, such as damaged-goods markdowns, in addition to their own sales duties.
Admin	Full access: all reports, all settings, inventory editing, staff management, and every screen in this guide.

Exactly what each non-admin role can see and do is fully customizable per person — the table above describes the typical intent, not a fixed limit.

4.3 Opening the Register Each Day

Each trading day needs an opening float declared before the register can be used (the same float step from setup — Section 3.2). If the computer is left on overnight, the app automatically notices the new day and prompts for a fresh float the next time someone tries to sell.

4.4 Automatic Logout

To keep an unattended register secure, The Gift Shop POS automatically signs staff out after a period of inactivity (15 minutes by default — adjustable in Admin settings). You'll get a 60-second warning banner first; tap anywhere on the screen to stay logged in.

5. Making a Sale — The Register Screen

This is the main screen staff will use all day. It has two layout options, switchable at any time:

- Grid view — a visual, tap-friendly grid of product tiles with photos, best for a touchscreen till.
- Quick/Scan view — a compact, keyboard- and scanner-first list, best when most sales come from barcode scanning.

5.1 Finding & Adding Items

Use the search bar (press "/" to jump straight to it) to find an item by name, SKU/barcode, size, or design. Filter by brand or category using the dropdown filters above the product grid.

Scanning a barcode adds the item instantly — a small floating confirmation shows what was just scanned, and a "Last 5 Scanned" mini-feed on screen lets the cashier glance back at recent activity without disrupting the sale in progress. Scanning the same item twice in quick succession is recognized as "+1 quantity" rather than two separate scans.

5.2 Adjusting the Cart

Tap +/- to change quantity, or the trash icon to remove a line entirely. An "undo last scan" control instantly reverses the most recent addition if a wrong item gets scanned.

5.3 Damaged Goods Markdown

If an item is sold at a markdown because it's damaged or shop-worn, mark that specific line as "Damaged" in the cart and set the markdown percentage (50% by default, adjustable per item). This keeps an accurate record of why a line sold below its normal price, separate from ordinary discounts. Depending on their permissions, some staff need a Shift Lead or Manager PIN to approve this before it applies.

5.4 Attaching a Customer

Use "Lookup Customer" to attach an existing customer profile to the sale (for loyalty points and purchase history), or create a new profile on the spot. Attaching a customer with a Wholesale or VIP profile automatically applies their pricing tier to the sale — see Section 5.6.

5.5 Holding a Cart (Serving Multiple Customers)

Mid-sale and need to help someone else first? Use "Hold Cart" to park the current basket and start a fresh one. Held carts appear in a list and can be recalled at any time — nothing is lost, even if the app is closed and reopened, or the computer restarts unexpectedly.

5.6 Pricing Tiers & Multi-Register Setup

If your store sells to more than one type of customer — retail walk-ins, wholesale trade accounts, VIP members — Admin can define separate Pricing Tiers, each with its own discount percentage or custom per-item pricing (Section 14.1). The active tier for the current sale is shown near the top of the screen and

can be switched manually, or set automatically per physical till (for example, a dedicated "Wholesale & Trade Desk" register that always opens on wholesale pricing).

5.7 Order-Level Discounts

Beyond per-item damaged markdowns, a whole-order discount (percentage or fixed amount) can be applied at checkout for promotions, loyalty perks, or manager-approved price matching.

6. Completing a Sale — Checkout

Tapping Checkout opens the payment screen, which shows a full breakdown of the sale — subtotal, any discounts, VAT/tax, and the final total — before payment is taken.

6.1 Payment Methods

Method	Notes
Cash	Enter the amount tendered; change due is calculated automatically.
Card	Record the sale as paid by card (for stores using a separate physical card terminal alongside the till).
Split Tender	Divide one sale across multiple payment lines and even multiple currencies — useful when a customer pays partly in local cash and partly by card, for example.
Gift Card	Accept a store gift card as payment.

6.2 Multi-Currency Sales

If a secondary currency is configured (common for stores in tourist areas — e.g. accepting US Dollars alongside the local currency), the checkout screen can accept and calculate change in either currency using the exchange rate set in Admin settings (Section 14.8). Split-tender payments can mix currencies on the same sale, each converted back to your primary currency automatically for reporting.

6.3 Receipts

Once payment is confirmed, a receipt can be printed on a thermal receipt printer (80mm or 58mm width) or a standard printer, sent as a digital receipt (a QR code the customer scans with their own phone, which also lets them leave a satisfaction rating — Section 14.9), or both. "Gift Receipt" mode prints a copy with prices hidden, for gift-giving.

6.4 Tax-Free Export (Tourist Purchases)

For tourist customers eligible for VAT-free export, the checkout flow can capture their passport details, travel information, and preferred refund method, then produce a Tax-Free Export Certificate alongside the normal receipt.

7. Refunds & Returns

Open "Process Refund" from the sidebar, look up the original receipt, and select which items are being returned. The refund is linked back to the original transaction for accurate reporting, and inventory can be automatically restocked if the returned items are resellable. A reason for the refund is captured for your records.

8. Customer-Facing Display

The Gift Shop POS supports a second screen facing the customer — either a small dedicated pole display or a second monitor — showing the running cart, subtotal, tax, and total as items are scanned, exactly as the cashier sees them.

Customers can toggle the display between currencies themselves (for example, seeing the total in both local currency and US Dollars) without interrupting the sale. Open it from the sidebar as a docked preview, or launch it as its own separate window to drag onto a second monitor — screen size and zoom level for a dedicated pole display can be fine-tuned in Admin → Hardware.

9. Managing Inventory

The Inventory screen is your product catalog: every item's name, brand, category, size/variant, barcode (SKU), stock level, cost, and retail price lives here.

9.1 Adding & Editing Products

Add products one at a time with full detail (brand, category, product line, size, variant/design, cost basis, retail price, VAT rate, reorder threshold, and linked vendor), or edit any existing item the same way.

9.2 Categories, Sizing & the Apparel Matrix

Category tabs organize the product grid on the register screen and are fully renameable. For apparel and similar variant-heavy products, the Apparel Matrix tool generates a full grid of size/color (or design) combinations in one step, rather than creating each variant by hand. "Quick Sizing Pills" — reusable presets for common sizes, scents, materials, and artwork — speed up adding new items by hand.

9.3 Bulk CSV Import

Bring in a whole catalog at once from a spreadsheet (CSV file), with automatic category assignment rules and a configurable VAT calculation mode for the import. Ready-made "Quick Catalog Presets" are also available as a starting template if you're building your catalog from scratch.

9.4 Low Stock Alerts

Items are flagged automatically once their stock falls at or below the reorder threshold you set for that product. The alert count is always visible in the sidebar; opening it lists every low-stock item in one place.

10. Vendors & Consignment

Many gift shops carry goods from local makers and craftspeople rather than owning all their own stock outright. The Gift Shop POS has this built in as a first-class concept, alongside ordinary wholesale-purchased inventory.

10.1 Vendor Profiles

Each vendor record stores contact details, payout terms (e.g. Net 30, bi-weekly, immediate), and — for consignment suppliers — the commission split (what percentage the house keeps vs. what the vendor is paid when their item sells).

10.2 Consignment Payout Reports

Run a settlement for any consignment vendor over a date range: total units sold, gross sales, the house's commission, and the resulting payout owed. Once paid, mark the settlement as Paid to keep a clean history.

10.3 Vendor Advances

Record any advance payments made to a vendor ahead of a formal settlement — these are automatically netted off their next payout so nothing gets double-paid.

10.4 Vendor Settlement Ledger

A full, itemized statement per vendor — every sale, refund, advance, and settlement — for complete traceability from a single deposited item through to the cash paid out.

11. Invoices, Quotes & Purchase Orders

Beyond till sales, the Invoices section handles formal paperwork: customer invoices, price quotes, and purchase orders to your own suppliers.

- Choose payment terms (due on receipt, Net 15/30/60, or a custom due date) and the document auto-calculates the due date.
- Tax can be applied to the whole subtotal or line-by-line, matching how your accountant expects it.
- Record partial or full payments against an invoice as they come in, and log collections follow-ups (call, email, letter, in person) for anything overdue.

12. Reports & Analytics

All reporting lives under the Reports tab, organized into focused sub-sections. Exactly which of these a non-admin staff member can see is controlled per person in Admin → Staff & Cashier Security.

12.1 End of Day (EOD) Balancing

Cash drawer history and audit trail for every trading day: opening float, cash and card sales, paid-ins/paid-outs, expected vs. actual counted cash, and the resulting over/short difference.

12.2 Financial Reports (Profit & Loss)

Revenue trends, top brands and product lines, category and size-variant performance, and a P&L view that separates wholesale-owned inventory from consignment goods (since your true margin differs between the two).

12.3 Sales Heatmap

A day-of-week × hour-of-day heatmap showing your busiest trading windows, plus a monthly calendar view of daily sales — useful for staff scheduling and spotting seasonal patterns.

12.4 Sales Forecasting

Predictive demand sensing based on your historical sales, to help with reorder timing and cash flow planning.

12.5 Transaction History

A searchable ledger of every receipt, with a built-in auditor that flags line-item price drift or calculation discrepancies for review.

12.6 Tax Return Assistant

Pulls your recorded sales figures directly into a general income-tax-return-style worksheet (taxpayer details, gross income, deductions, and final calculation) as a starting point for you or your accountant — it is a data summary tool, not tax advice, and doesn't replace a qualified preparer.

12.7 Downloads

Export report data for record-keeping or handing to your accountant.

13. Closing the Shop (End of Day)

13.1 Cash Drawer Movements

Log any cash movements during the day as they happen — cash paid into the drawer, cash paid out, or a cash drop to the safe — so the end-of-day count reconciles correctly.

13.2 Closing Shift

At the end of the day, open "Close Shop" to count the physical cash in the drawer. The app compares your counted total against the expected total (opening float + cash sales + paid-ins – paid-outs – drops) and records any difference. This closes the day's EOD session and generates the shift summary that feeds Section 12.1.

14. Admin Settings Reference

Everything below lives behind the Admin login. It's organized into six master sections, each with its own sub-tabs.

14.1 Register — Workstations, Pricing Tiers & Multi-Currency

Define Pricing Tiers (e.g. Standard Retail, Wholesale, VIP) with their discount percentages, and Physical Workstations (each till/counter in your store), assigning each workstation a default pricing tier. A background sync engine automatically recalculates every item's price across all tiers whenever a tier's discount changes, with a log of every recalculation.

A bulk price adjuster is also here, for applying an across-the-board price change (e.g. a seasonal +/-X%) to a filtered set of inventory in one action.

14.2 Staff & Cashier Security

Create and manage staff accounts, assign roles (Section 4.2), reset a forgotten PIN, suspend or delete an account, and — most importantly — set individual "security gates" per staff member: fine-grained on/off switches for exactly which areas (inventory editing, reports, refunds, discounts, damaged markdowns, manual drawer opening, closing the day, and more) that specific person can access, overriding the store-wide defaults when needed.

14.3 Product Management

Three sub-tabs: Pricing (Section 14.1), Category Tabs (rename or reorder the tabs shown on the register screen), and the Category Presets & Quick Sizing Pill Manager, where you customize the size/scent/material/design pills offered when adding items, and manage reusable Quick Catalog Presets for bulk-import templates.

14.4 Barcode Rule Engine

For stores with non-standard barcodes — for example, in-store scale labels with the weight or price embedded directly in the barcode digits — define custom rules by prefix, suffix, exact match, or pattern, and what the scanner should do when it matches (add to cart, look up the item, apply a discount, etc.). A built-in simulator lets you test a rule by typing a sample barcode, without needing the physical scanner in hand.

14.5 Hardware

Configure how your physical barcode scanner connects (most USB/Bluetooth laser scanners work in the default "HID" keyboard-emulation mode with no drivers needed; some purpose-built scanners need "Serial/COM" mode instead), and calibrate the resolution and zoom of a dedicated customer pole display if you're using one (Section 8).

14.6 Receipts & White Label

Upload your store logo and set the header/footer text and policy notes that print on every receipt, choose thermal vs. standard printer output and the thermal paper width, and verify printer alignment with a test print. The White Label sub-tab is where you set your own app name, short badge initials,

theme color, and can rename the main navigation tabs (Register, Inventory, Vendors, Payouts, Reports) to match your own store's terminology.

14.7 Email, WhatsApp & Peripherals

Connect an email account (SMTP) so digital receipts and reports can be sent by email, and/or a WhatsApp Business webhook for sending receipts over WhatsApp — popular with tourist-facing shops whose customers may not want to share an email address.

14.8 Store System & Audits

General store settings: your primary and secondary currency and today's exchange rate, the automatic update checker, and the admin username/password. This is also where you'll find the master VAT rate and whether shelf prices already include VAT or have it added at checkout.

14.9 Customer Feedback

When a customer scans the QR code on a digital receipt, they can leave a 1–5 star rating, a comment, and pick which area of their visit stood out. This tab shows the running average rating, total reviews, and the most commonly praised area — a quick pulse-check on customer experience with no extra hardware needed.

15. Backups & Data Safety

Because The Gift Shop POS runs locally on your own computer, your data is only as safe as your backup habits. The app helps with this automatically, but it's worth understanding how it works.

- Scheduled auto-backup runs daily at a time you set, and can also trigger automatically whenever you close out the day (Section 13.2).
- A manual backup/export can be triggered any time from the Admin panel.
- Backups can save in database format, a plain JSON export, or both.
- A JSON export is also the easiest way to move your whole store — products, sales history, settings — onto a second computer: export on the first machine, then import that file on the second.

Store a copy of your backups somewhere other than the same computer (a USB drive, cloud storage folder, or email to yourself) — a backup that lives only on the machine it's protecting won't help if that machine is lost, stolen, or damaged.

16. Troubleshooting & FAQ

“Windows/Mac says the file is damaged or can't verify the developer.”

This is expected for independently distributed software — see Section 2 for the exact steps for your operating system. It is not a sign of a corrupted download.

“I forgot the admin PIN and no one else has admin access.”

Contact your supplier's support email for help recovering access rather than guessing — they can confirm you're the rightful store owner and get you back in safely.

“The barcode scanner isn't adding items.”

Check Admin → Hardware and confirm the scanner connectivity mode matches your device (most scanners want "HID" mode). You can test scanning behavior there without needing a real sale in progress.

“Receipts aren't printing.”

Confirm the correct printer type (thermal vs. standard) and paper width are selected in Admin → Receipts & White Label, and use the "Verify Printer Drivers & Alignment" test print to confirm the connection.

“I want to move my store to a new computer.”

Export a backup on the old computer (Section 15) and import it on the new one during — or instead of — the first-time setup wizard.

17. Getting Support

If you run into anything this guide doesn't cover, reach out to your supplier using the contact details provided at the time of purchase, or the support email shown on the license activation screen inside the app.